

Brom Emberhold — Hill Dwarf Cleric (Light Domain)



Figure 1: Character portrait

Class: Cleric (Light Domain, locked) **Race:** Hill Dwarf **Level:** 3 **Role:** Team sustain + reactive defender + radiant-AoE finisher **Personality Hook:** *Claims the dawn owes him a favor. Walks into shadow like he's expecting it to move for him.*

Core Stats

Ability Scores (Point Buy 27, +Hill Dwarf racial +2 CON / +1 WIS)

Ability	Score	Mod
STR	14	+2
DEX	10	+0
CON	16	+3
INT	8	-1
WIS	16	+3
CHA	12	+1

Combat Vitals

- **HP: 44** (base 28 at L3 with CON 16 + **10 HP variant buffer** + **3 Dwarven Toughness** +1/level + 3 levels)
- **AC: 18** (Chain Mail 16 + Shield +2)
- **Speed:** 25 ft (Dwarf base, no speed reduction from heavy armor via Dwarven ability)
- **Initiative:** +0
- **Proficiency Bonus:** +2
- **Hit Dice:** 3d8

Saving Throws: WIS +5, CHA +3

Skill Proficiencies: Religion +1, Medicine +5, Insight +5, Perception +5

Tool Proficiencies: Mason's tools (Dwarf), Smith's tools (Dwarf)

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft

Languages: Common, Dwarvish, Celestial (Light Domain bonus)

Spell Save DC: 13 · **Spell Attack:** +5

Equipment

- **Warhammer** (1d8 bludgeoning, versatile d10) — primary melee
- **Mace** (1d6 bludgeoning) — backup
- **Light Crossbow** (1d8 piercing, ranged 80/320, loading, two-handed) — ranged option
- **20x Bolts**
- **Chain Mail** (AC 16, Dwarf immunity to speed reduction)
- **Shield** (+2 AC)
- **Holy Symbol** (emblem emblazoned on shield) — spellcasting focus
- **Priest's Pack** (prayer book, vestments, 5 sticks incense, tinderbox, candles, alms box, rations, waterskin)
- **Starting trinket:** A sun-disc medallion worn smooth from thumbing during prayer

Spell Slots & Preparation

Slots: 4× 1st, 2× 2nd **Prepared Spells:** **WIS mod (+3) + Cleric level (3) = 6 prepared** (+ Domain spells always prepared on top, don't count vs limit)

Cantrips Known (3):

- **Sacred Flame** (1d8 radiant, 60 ft, DEX save — **no cover benefit**) — primary ranged cantrip, ignores cover
- **Guidance** (1 action, 1 min, touch, +1d4 to one ability check) — town phase staple, pre-combat buff
- **Light** (40 ft radius light on an object, 1 hour) — utility + Light Domain thematic fit

Prepared 1st-Level Spells (chosen — 6 total, + 2 Light Domain always-prepared):

1. **Cure Wounds** (1 action, touch, $1d8 + 3 \text{ WIS} = \text{avg } 7.5$) — core single-target heal. Upcastable.
2. **Healing Word** (bonus action, 60 ft, $1d4 + 3 \text{ WIS} = \text{avg } 5.5$) — **60-ft bonus action heal** — keeps downed allies up from across the arena. Essential.
3. **Bless** (concentration, 1 min, 3 targets + $1d4$ to attack rolls AND saves) — team buffer. Note: concentration conflict if Mat also casts Bless on Paladin; only one Bless at a time per team.
4. **Shield of Faith** (bonus action, concentration, 60 ft, +2 AC to one target for 10 min) — defensive alternative to Bless; drop on the Barbarian or Rogue for a +2 AC bump.
5. **Guiding Bolt** (1 action, 120 ft, ranged spell attack, $4d6$ radiant + next attacker has advantage against target until your next turn) — avg 14 damage + a setup buff for teammates. **Great use of a slot.**
6. **Inflict Wounds** (1 action, touch, $3d10$ necrotic = avg 16.5) — melee nova option; used if you're already in melee and a 1st-slot burst is worth it.

Always Prepared (Light Domain):

- **Burning Hands** (3d6 fire, 15 ft cone, DEX save) — AoE option, avg 10.
- **Faerie Fire** (concentration, 1 min, 20 ft cube, DEX save; on fail targets shed dim light and attacks against them have advantage) — **the team-wide advantage enabler**. Huge Sneak Attack and crit-fishing setup. Save-based, not attack roll. Best turn-1 control spell.

Prepared 2nd-Level Spells:

- **Spiritual Weapon** (bonus action, 1 min, 60 ft, $1d8 + 3$ force damage on summon and on each subsequent bonus action) — the Cleric's best DPS spell. Bonus-action damage every turn once cast, no concentration. **Should be cast Round 1 or Round 2 and then attacked with every turn thereafter.**
- **Spiritual Weapon upcast** option if needed.

(Second 2nd-level slot held for upcast Cure Wounds, upcast Healing Word, or upcast Spiritual Weapon as situational.)

Note — Sleep isn't on the Cleric list, so the variant ban doesn't affect him.

Light Domain Features

- **Bonus Cantrip: Light** (free, doesn't count vs cantrips known — already listed above).
- **Warding Flare (L1): Reaction.** When a creature within 30 ft of you makes an attack roll and you can see it, **impose disadvantage on the attack roll**. Uses = **WIS mod (3)/long rest**, resets on town (long rest). **Does not work on creatures immune to Blinded**. This is your big defensive trick — it's the "don't let the Paladin get crit" button.
- **Channel Divinity — Radiance of the Dawn (L2): Action.** 30 ft radius from you, magical darkness dispelled, each hostile creature in range makes a CON save DC 13; on fail **2d10 + 3 radiant damage**, on success half. **Cannot be reduced by resistance to radiant**. **1/short rest**. In v1 (1 fight/match) this is effectively 1/match.
- **Channel Divinity — Turn Undead (L2):** Standard Cleric option; unlikely to matter in PVP (no undead PCs) but still available.

Hill Dwarf Features

- **Darkvision 60 ft**
- **Dwarven Resilience:** Advantage on saves vs. **poison**, resistance to **poison damage**.
- **Dwarven Combat Training:** Proficiency with battleaxe, handaxe, light hammer, warhammer.

- **Stonecunning:** Double proficiency on History checks related to stone origins.
- **Speed not reduced by heavy armor** (when STR requirement not met). Base speed **25 ft** always, including in Chain Mail.
- **Dwarven Toughness:** **+1 HP per Cleric level** (already factored into 44 HP above).

Signature Tactical Moves

1. **Round 1 Open: Faerie Fire + Spiritual Weapon.** Turn 1: **Faerie Fire** (concentration, 20 ft cube on the enemy team's frontline — DEX save DC 13, on fail they shed dim light, **all attacks against them have advantage**). Turn 2: **Spiritual Weapon** as a bonus action (summon 60 ft away, avg 7.5 damage attack) + **Action: attack with Warhammer** (1d8 + 2 = avg 6.5) or upcast a heal. The whole team gets advantage for a round — equivalent to 5-6 characters' worth of hit-rate buff.
2. **Warding Flare Saves a Life.** When a crit rolls against your Paladin or Rogue: **reaction** — **Warding Flare, disadvantage on the attack.** Turns a crit into likely a miss. 3/match uses — spend them on the highest-stakes incoming hits.
3. **Radiance of the Dawn Finisher.** When the enemy team is clustered and bloodied (round 4-5): **Action** — **Radiance of the Dawn.** 2d10 + 3 radiant (avg 14) to every hostile in 30 ft, CON save DC 13 for half. **Ignores resistance.** 3 enemies in range = ~42 total radiant damage from one action. Closer the game, better the spell.

Action Economy (Quick Reference)

Slot	Options
Action	Attack (Warhammer 1d8+2 blud · Light Crossbow 1d8 pierce at +2 to hit, range 80/320) · Cast Spell (Cure Wounds / Guiding Bolt / Burning Hands / Faerie Fire / Inflict Wounds) · Sacred Flame (cantrip, 1d8 radiant, DEX save) · Channel Divinity — Radiance of the Dawn or Turn Undead (1/short rest) · Dash · Dodge
Bonus Action	Healing Word (60 ft, 1d4+3 HP) · Shield of Faith cast (+2 AC on ally) · Spiritual Weapon attack (1d8+3 force, 60 ft, already summoned) · Spiritual Weapon summon (first cast only)
Reaction	Warding Flare (disadvantage on incoming attack within 30 ft, 3/match) · Opportunity Attack
Movement	25 ft
Free	Hold holy symbol as focus; declare prayer one-liners (flavor)

Damage & Healing Reference

- **Sacred Flame:** 1d8 radiant, DEX save DC 13, **no cover benefit** = avg 4.5 (cantrip, infinite)
- **Guiding Bolt (1st slot):** 4d6 radiant + next attacker advantage = **avg 14 + setup**
- **Spiritual Weapon (2nd slot, per bonus action):** 1d8 + 3 force = **avg 7.5/turn** (no concentration, no re-cost)
- **Radiance of the Dawn (CD):** 2d10 + 3 radiant, CON save half, **ignores resistance** = **avg 14/target**
- **Burning Hands (1st):** 3d6 fire, 15 ft cone save = avg 10

- **Inflict Wounds (1st):** 3d10 necrotic = avg 16.5 (melee, attack roll)
- **Warhammer melee:** 1d8 + 2 = avg 6.5
- **Cure Wounds (1st):** 1d8 + 3 = **avg 7.5 HP**
- **Healing Word (1st, bonus action, 60 ft):** 1d4 + 3 = **avg 5.5 HP**

Town Phase Notes

- **Insight +5 + Perception +5 + Medicine +5** — strong at Hag's Riddles (Insight reads social cues) and hunting the Catacombs.
- **Religion +1** (low — INT 8 penalty; but +2 prof). Knows the Shrine/Sanctum options.
- **WIS 16 + Perception +5** — excellent map intel gatherer.
- **Dwarven Toughness + stacked HP** means he can absorb a Catacombs monster encounter cost better than most.
- Town spending priority: **a Potion of Healing or two** as insurance against his Healing Word going dry. He's the team's healing engine — don't let him run out of slots mid-match.